

Skills

A skill is a block of conversation that has a clear purpose and that your bot can execute to achieve a goal. It can be as simple as the ability to greet someone, but it can also be more complex, like giving movie suggestions based on information provided by the user.

It need not be just a one query-answer set, but rather, skills running through multiple exchanges. For example, consider a bot which helps you learn about currency exchange rates. It starts by asking the source currency, then the target currency, before giving the exact response. Skills can be combined to create complex conversational flows.

Here's how you create a skill for the joke bot:

- Go to the *Build* tab. Click on the + icon to create a skill.
- Name the skill *Joke* (Figure 8)
- Once created, click on the skill. You will see four tabs. *Read me*, *Triggers*, *Requirements* and *Actions*.
- Navigate to the *Requirements* tab. You should store the information only if the intent joke is present. So, add a requirement as shown in Figure 9.

Since this is a simple use case, you needn't consider any specific requirements in the *Requirement* tab but consider a case for which a response needs to be triggered only if certain keywords or entities are present – in such a case you will need 'requirements'.

Requirements are either intents or entities that your skill needs to retrieve before executing actions. Requirements are pieces of information that are important in the conversation and that your bot can use; for example, the user's name or a location. Once a requirement is completed, the associated value is stored in the bot's memory for the entire conversation.

Now let us move to the *Action* tab to set the responses (see Figure 10).

Click on *Add new message group*. Then select *Send message* and add a

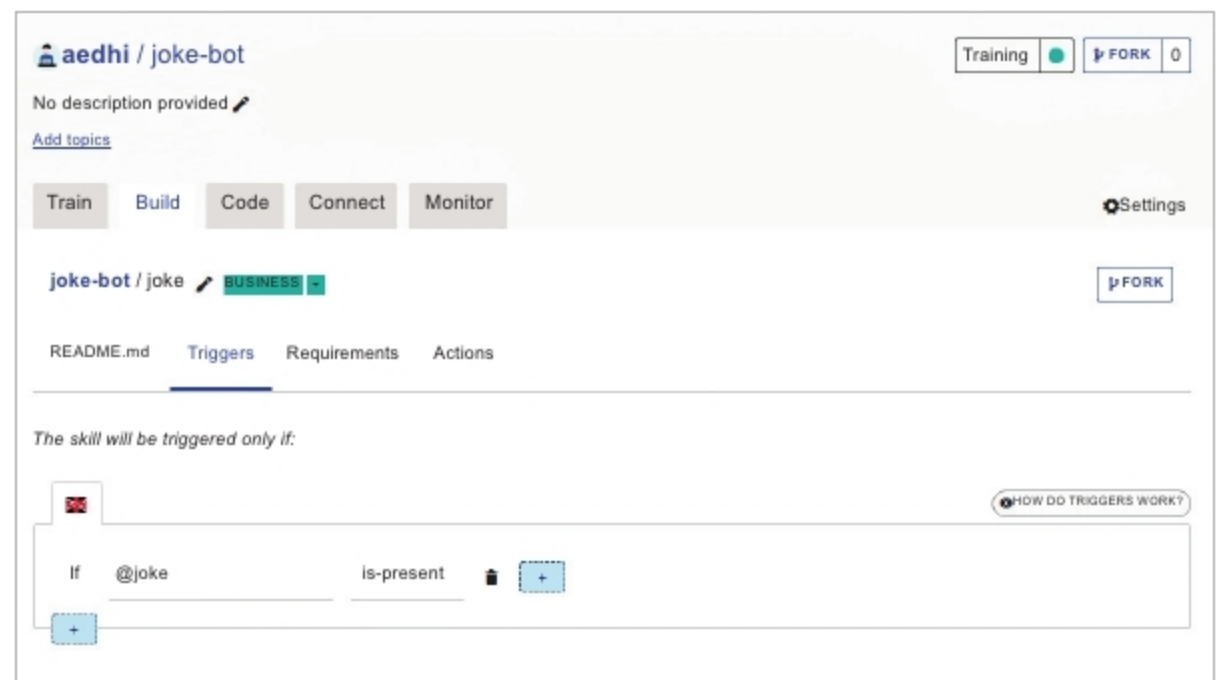


Figure 9: Adding a trigger

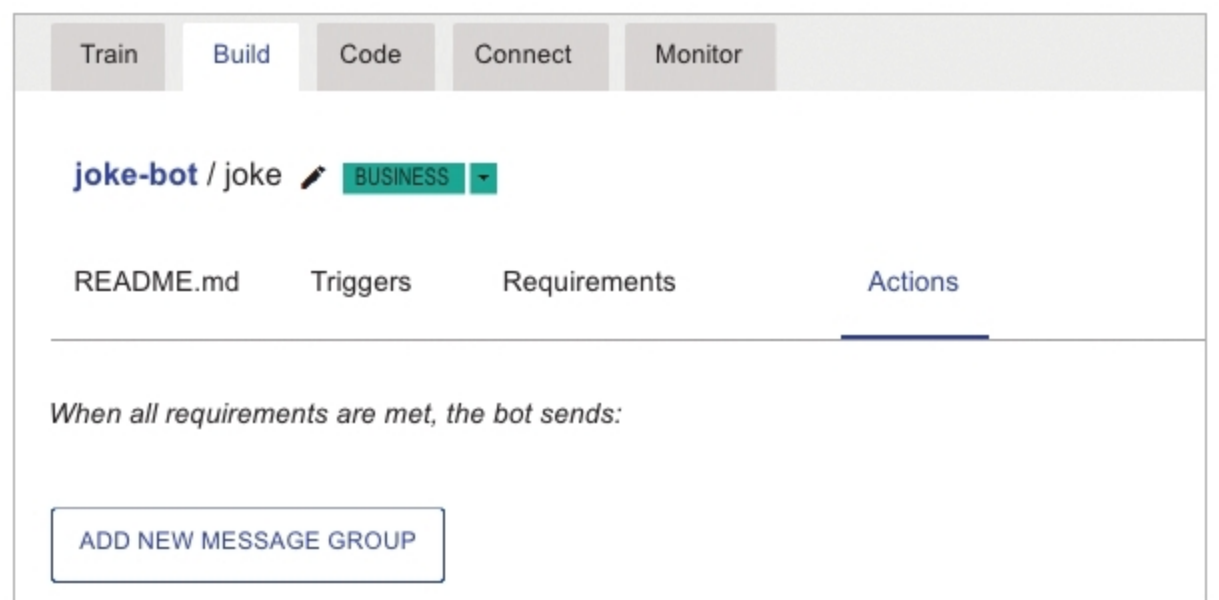


Figure 10: Adding actions

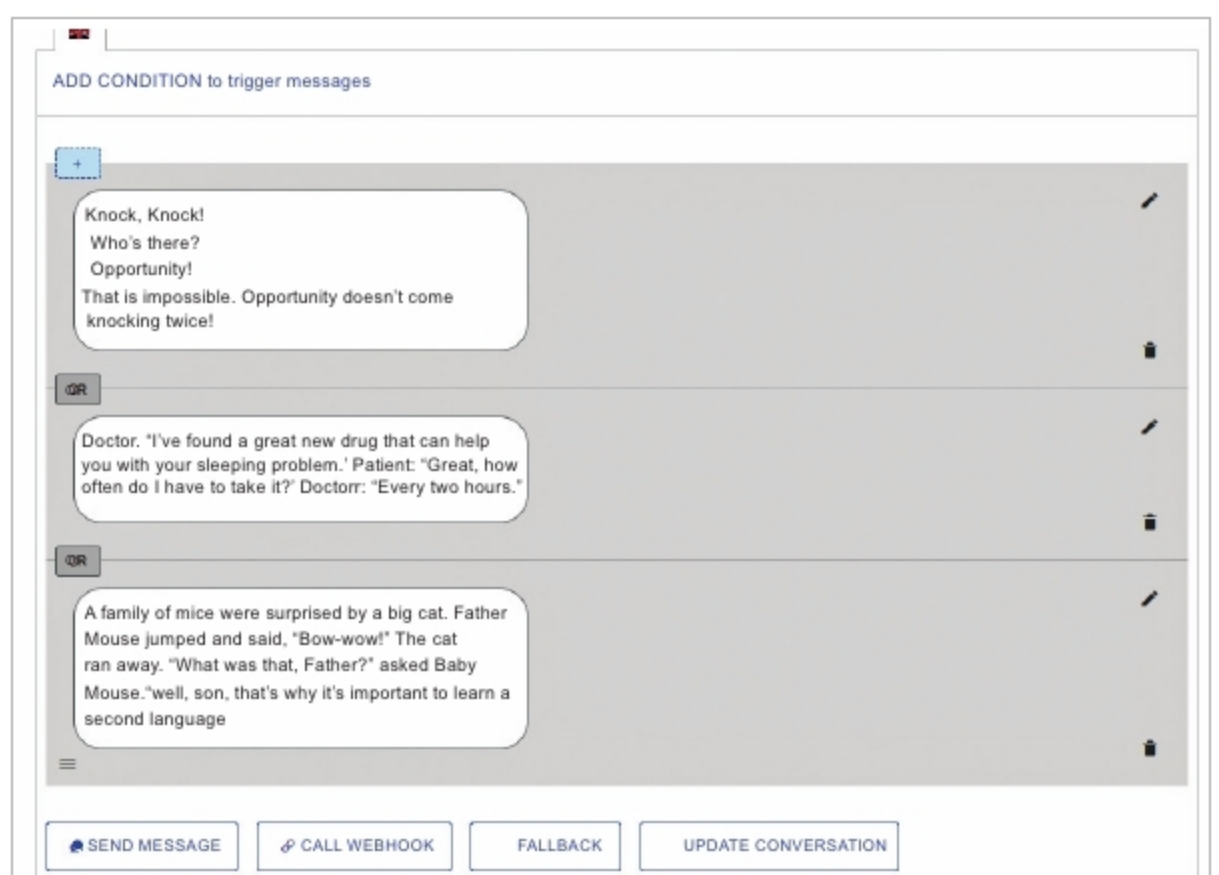


Figure 11: Adding text messages